

Exploratory Testing Summary Report — AcademyBugs.com

Application Under Test: AcademyBugs.com (uTest practice site — 25 bugs deliberately planted)

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Testing Type: Unscripted Exploratory Testing (Session-Based Test Management approach)

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● 1. Test Charter

Mission: Explore the AcademyBugs.com e-commerce site to identify defects across all five categories the site tests for (Functional, Visual, Content, Performance, Crash), with particular emphasis on UI/UX-relevant issues (Visual and Content categories), using Nielsen's Usability Heuristics as a guiding framework rather than pre-written test scripts.

Areas Explored:

- Homepage / product listing (including sorting and price filtering)
- Product detail pages (color selection, add to cart, social share icons, manufacturer links)
- Shopping cart (mini-cart hover, full cart page, cart totals)
- Sign-in / New User / Forgot Password flows
- Account page (billing address)
- Blog/comment submission



● 2. Approach

This session used **exploratory testing** — simultaneous learning, test design, and execution without a pre-written script — rather than pre-defined, scripted test cases. Testing was guided by:

- **Nielsen's 10 Usability Heuristics** (visibility of system status, consistency, error prevention, aesthetic/minimalist design, etc.) to identify Visual and Content issues with a defensible framework rather than subjective impression
- **General error-guessing techniques** (trying edge-case interactions, checking calculated values against manual math, testing form submissions) to surface Functional, Performance, and Crash issues
- The site's own five-category structure (Functional, Visual, Content, Performance, Crash) as a coverage checklist to ensure the session didn't over-focus on one category

● 3. Session Results

CATEGORY	FINDINGS DOCUMENTED	NOTES
FUNCTIONAL	4	Includes one high-severity, mathematically verified calculation error (Grand Total)
VISUAL	4	Layout/alignment/overlap issues, aligned to Nielsen's "aesthetic and minimalist design" and "consistency" heuristics
CONTENT	5	Includes placeholder text, spelling errors, and an untranslated string
PERFORMANCE	2	Loading delays and unresponsiveness
CRASH	3	Consistent ~5-second lockout pattern across three different trigger actions



CATEGORY	FINDINGS DOCUMENTED	NOTES
TOTAL	18 findings (17 officially registered by site tracker)	See note below on tracker discrepancy

Overall tracker result: 17 out of 25 planted bugs found.

Note on discrepancy: 18 issues were independently identified and documented during this session, while the site's own tracker registered 17 as "found." This is attributed to submission/registration issues encountered with a small number of findings (a known limitation of the site's tracking widget), not to duplicate or invalid findings — each of the 18 documented issues is a distinct, reproducible defect.

4. Key Finding Worth Highlighting

FUNCTIONAL-03 (Grand Total Calculation Error) stands out as the strongest finding from this session: rather than relying on a "this looks wrong" impression, the displayed Cart Subtotal (\$559.80) and Shipping (\$7.99) were manually summed (\$567.79) and compared against the displayed Grand Total (\$667.79) — confirming an exact \$100.00 discrepancy. This demonstrates the value of verifying displayed calculations rather than only checking for visual plausibility.

5. Heuristics-to-Findings Mapping (UI/UX Focus)

HEURISTIC VIOLATED	RELATED FINDING(S)
CONSISTENCY AND STANDARDS	VISUAL-02 (inconsistent product card spacing), CONTENT-05 (spelling inconsistency)
AESTHETIC AND MINIMALIST DESIGN	VISUAL-01 (loading spinner overlapping logo), VISUAL-03 (search box overlapping footer)
MATCH BETWEEN SYSTEM AND REAL WORLD	CONTENT-03 (placeholder Lorem Ipsum text), CONTENT-04 (untranslated Russian text)

HEURISTIC VIOLATED	RELATED FINDING(S)
VISIBILITY OF SYSTEM STATUS	PERFORMANCE-02 (billing address stuck loading with no error/timeout message)
ERROR PREVENTION / RECOGNITION	VISUAL-04 (password label misalignment reducing form clarity)

● 6. Coverage Gaps / Not Explored

- 8 planted bugs (25 total minus 17 found) remain unidentified — likely distributed across categories not yet exhaustively explored (e.g., deeper checkout/payment flow, account settings beyond billing address, additional product variants)
- **Responsiveness:** Layout responsiveness was checked using Chrome DevTools' device toolbar (viewport/breakpoint simulation), but no responsiveness defects were found during this pass.
- **Root-cause analysis:** This session focused on identifying and documenting defects at the black-box level. DevTools was used for the responsiveness check, but deeper root-cause analysis (e.g., inspecting the DOM/network requests behind the Grand Total miscalculation or the crash-bug lockouts) was not performed in this pass.

● 7. Conclusion

This session successfully applied structured exploratory testing techniques — guided by usability heuristics rather than ad hoc impressions — to identify 18 distinct defects across all five bug categories on a purpose-built practice site. The strongest outcome was a verifiable, high-severity calculation defect (Grand Total), demonstrating that even in an unscripted exploratory session, findings can be backed by concrete evidence rather than subjective judgment.

